

different times.

To display the alert message at the time of booting, you can place the .exe file in the directory as given below:

```
D:\documents and settings\all users\
Start Menu\programs\start up\ alert.
exe (for all users)
```

Or

```
D:\Documents and Settings\janaki\
Start Menu\Programs\Start up\alert.
exe (for particular user)
```

You can also place the .exe file in 'programs' folder to execute it at a later convenient time. In this case, the .exe file appears in 'All Programs' under 'Start' button on the desktop. The path for this setting is:

```
D:\Documents and Settings\janaki\
Start Menu\Programs\alert.exe
```

If your operating system is installed in another drive, you have to specify the correct drive and path accordingly.

Database access, special ADO (active data object) controls and datagrid of the program have not been discussed here much due to limitation of the space. Only the important control properties have been explained here. The program was tested on Windows XP using Microsoft Visual Basic 6 and Microsoft Access version 11.

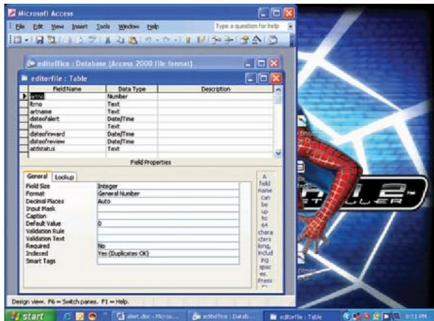
Program design

The program is based on a single form and simple Visual Basic (VB) code. Since this program is a Microsoft Access application, before you design the form, you need to create a database using Microsoft Access. Launch Microsoft Access application, then select 'create table in DesignView' option. In the screen displayed, enter the field names and data types as shown in Screenshot 3, then save the table as 'editorfile' and the database as 'editoffice'.

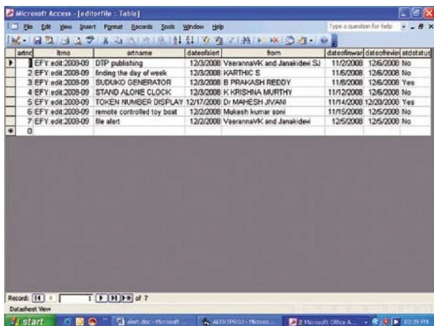
Next, reopen the table by double-clicking it and enter the records as shown in Screenshot 4.

Form design

For form design, as in many of VB articles, open a new project and place controls on the form displayed. Place



Screenshot 3: DesignView output screen for creating editorfile table



Screenshot 4: Various items (attended and unattended) in editorfile table

a label, adjust its position, change the back and fore colour, then change its caption property to "alert on letters to attend immediately" as shown in Screenshot 5. Place another label on the form, position and resize it, and change its name property to 'mestatusbar.' Next, place a textbox control, resize and position it, then change its datasource property to 'estado' and

field property to 'artno' (this has to be done after the ADO properties are set). Now place a command button control, position and resize it, then change its caption property to 'view,' style to 'graphical' and back colour to 'pink.'

To access the database from the VB environment, you need to use an ADO control. This is not a normal control; you need to add it to the general con-